

opening a potential door for compromise of privacy. Use this hack to disable the new search assistant and use the classic search interface.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Internet Explorer\Main

Set the String value for Use Search Asst to “no”. The default is “yes”.

Modify The Default Search Options

An incredibly useful hack! You’ve probably gone through the drill more than once—search, then specify that it’s case-sensitive, then specify that you want to search subfolders, and so on and so forth. Use this hack to specify the search parameters that makes it most comfortable for you to search your system.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer

Set any of the following DWORD Values to 1 or to 0. What to set them to is obvious.

CaseSensitive: Do a case-sensitive search

IncludeSubFolders: Search subfolders

SearchHidden: Search hidden files and folders

SearchSlowFiles: Search tape backup

SearchSystemDirs: Search system folders

The next time you conduct a search, you won’t need to enter a single parameter!

Change The Program Files And Common Files Directory

Change the default location where software will be installed and where the “common files” will be stored. These are normally found in C:\Program Files and C:\Program Files\Common Files\.. Both can be on independent volumes. This can be useful if, say, you’re running out of space on the C: drive, and want to instruct